SAECOIN

LICENSE & CONTRIBUTION TERMS

Document: License_and_Contribution_Terms.md
Project: SAECOIN
Ticker: SAC (Provisional)
Version: 1.0
Status: Draft — Legal Review Required
Date: October 2026

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1. Purpose

This document establishes the proposed licensing and contribution framework for SAECOIN.

Its objectives are to:

- Define how project software may be licensed.
- Establish contribution requirements.
- Protect contributor and project rights.
- Maintain source-code transparency.
- Define rules for accepting external contributions.
- Establish a consistent approach to copyright and attribution.

2. Scope

This document applies to contributions and project materials associated with:

- Blockchain Core.
- Full Node.
- Consensus Engine.
- Mining Software.
- Android Wallet.
- Windows Wallet.
- Explorer Backend.
- Explorer Frontend.
- Developer Tools.
- Build Scripts.
- Documentation.
- Tests and Examples.

Different components may use different licenses where technically or legally necessary.

3. Proposed Software License

The project proposes evaluating an open-source license for the SAECOIN software.

Potential candidates include:

3.1 MIT License

Characteristics:

- Permissive open-source license.
- Allows modification and redistribution.
- Allows commercial use.
- Requires preservation of copyright and license notices.

3.2 Apache License 2.0

Characteristics:

- Permissive open-source license.
- Allows commercial use and redistribution.
- Includes express patent-license provisions.
- Requires preservation of applicable notices.

3.3 GNU General Public License v3.0

Characteristics:

- Strong copyleft license.
- Distribution of modified covered software generally requires source-code availability under the license's conditions.
- Includes patent-related provisions.

4. License Selection

The final license has not been selected.

Before publication, the project must decide:

- Whether all components use one license.
- Whether different components require separate licenses.
- Whether strong copyleft or permissive licensing is preferred.
- Whether external dependencies are compatible.
- Whether contributor agreements are necessary.

No license should be assumed merely because this document mentions a candidate.

The final decision must be recorded in the repository using the appropriate license file.

5. Copyright Ownership

Every contributor retains rights in their contributions unless a separate valid agreement provides otherwise.

The project must establish a clear legal basis for accepting, maintaining, and distributing contributions.

Before accepting contributions, the project should determine:

- Whether copyright remains with each contributor.
- Whether contributors grant the project a license.
- Whether a Contributor License Agreement is required.
- Whether contributions are accepted under the repository's selected license.

No contributor's copyright should be transferred or claimed without an appropriate legal agreement.

6. Contribution Principles

SAECOIN welcomes contributions that improve the project's quality, security, reliability, and documentation.

Contributions should follow these principles:

1. Respectful communication.
2. Technical correctness.
3. Security awareness.
4. Clear documentation.
5. Reproducible testing.
6. Maintainable code.
7. Transparent review.
8. Proper attribution.

7. Contribution Eligibility

Contributors may include:

- Developers.
- Security researchers.
- Testers.
- Technical writers.
- UI designers.
- Documentation maintainers.
- Community members.

All contributions must comply with the project's contribution rules and applicable license requirements.

8. Contribution Workflow

The recommended workflow is:

Step 1 — Issue or Proposal

Before implementing a significant change, contributors should review existing issues and open decisions.

Major protocol changes should begin with a technical proposal.

Step 2 — Branch Creation

Contributors should work on separate branches.

Example:

"feature/transaction-validation"

Step 3 — Implementation

Changes should follow the project's Coding Standards.

Security-sensitive code requires additional care.

Step 4 — Testing

Contributors must provide relevant tests.

Consensus-critical changes must include tests demonstrating expected protocol behavior.

Step 5 — Pull Request

The contributor submits a pull request containing:

- Change summary.
- Motivation.
- Technical details.
- Test results.
- Compatibility impact.
- Security considerations where relevant.

Step 6 — Review

Maintainers review the proposed changes.

They may request revisions, additional tests, or independent technical review.

Step 7 — Approval and Merge

Only authorized maintainers may merge approved changes into protected branches.

9. Consensus-Critical Contributions

Consensus-related changes require special review.

Examples:

- Proof of Work algorithm.
- Difficulty adjustment.
- Block validation.
- Transaction validation.
- Subsidy calculation.
- Supply limits.
- UTXO rules.
- Cryptographic verification.
- Chain selection.

Such contributions must:

1. Reference the relevant protocol specification.
2. Explain compatibility consequences.
3. Include appropriate test cases.
4. Consider attack scenarios.
5. Receive additional review.
6. Be documented before release.

A consensus change must not be accepted solely because its implementation passes ordinary unit tests.

10. Security Vulnerability Reporting

Potential vulnerabilities should not necessarily be reported through public issues.

A private security-reporting channel should be established before public deployment.

Reports should include:

- Affected component.
- Software version.
- Vulnerability description.
- Reproduction information where safe.
- Potential impact.
- Suggested mitigation if known.

Researchers should avoid publishing exploit details before an appropriate coordinated disclosure process has been considered.

11. Third-Party Code and Dependencies

Contributors must not introduce third-party code without reviewing its license and origin.

Requirements:

- Identify the dependency.
- Record its version.
- Check license compatibility.
- Review known vulnerabilities.
- Preserve required notices.
- Avoid copying code without permission.
- Document significant dependency additions.

Software provenance should be maintained wherever practical.

12. Documentation Contributions

Documentation contributions should:

- Use clear language.
- Identify assumptions.
- Distinguish proposed rules from finalized rules.
- Include relevant examples.
- Avoid unsupported security claims.
- Identify outdated information.
- Reference related specifications.

Protocol documentation must remain consistent with the implemented and approved consensus rules.

13. Contributor Conduct

All project participants are expected to communicate respectfully.

The project should not tolerate:

- Harassment.
- Threats.
- Discrimination.
- Deliberate disruption.
- Malicious code submissions.
- Unauthorized disclosure of private information.
- Impersonation of maintainers.

A separate Code of Conduct may be adopted before public community participation begins.

14. Maintainer Responsibilities

Maintainers should:

- Review contributions fairly.
- Protect repository access.
- Maintain branch protection.
- Verify tests.
- Check license compatibility.
- Preserve project documentation.
- Review security implications.
- Record important decisions.
- Avoid merging unreviewed consensus changes.

Maintainer permissions should be limited to trusted individuals.

15. Attribution Requirements

Contributions must retain applicable copyright and attribution notices.

The project should maintain contributor records where appropriate.

Third-party license notices must not be removed or misrepresented.

16. Trademarks and Project Identity

The project name SAECOIN, ticker SAC, logos, and other branding elements may require separate trademark and intellectual-property decisions.

Software licensing does not automatically grant trademark rights.

The project must separately define:

- Name usage.
- Logo usage.
- Official website identity.
- Impersonation prevention.
- Community branding permissions.

No trademark ownership or registration is claimed by this draft.

17. License Compliance

Before every public release, the project should review:

- Main project license.
- Third-party dependency licenses.
- Copyright notices.

- Required attribution.
- Source-code distribution obligations.
- Applicable patent provisions.
- Distribution and packaging obligations.

License compliance should be documented.

18. Dispute Resolution

Disputes involving contributions, ownership, attribution, or licensing should first be reviewed through a documented project process.

If necessary, appropriate legal advice should be obtained.

The governing jurisdiction and formal dispute-resolution procedure have not been selected.

19. Required Repository Files

After the license is finalized, the repository should include appropriate files.

Example:

```
SAECOIN/
├── LICENSE
├── NOTICE
├── CONTRIBUTING.md
├── CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md
└── COPYRIGHT
```

Not every file is mandatory for every license.

The exact files depend on the selected license and legal review.

20. Current Project Limitations

At the time of this document:

- No final software license has been selected.
- No Contributor License Agreement has been adopted.
- No formal copyright ownership structure has been established.
- No trademark registration is being claimed.
- No formal Code of Conduct has been adopted.
- No legal jurisdiction has been designated for disputes.

These matters must be reviewed before accepting substantial public contributions or distributing production software.

21. Conclusion

This document establishes a proposed framework for software licensing and project contributions.

SAECOIN should maintain transparent licensing, respect contributor rights, review third-party dependencies, and apply strict review procedures to security-sensitive and consensus-critical changes.

Final licensing decisions must be made before public source-code distribution.

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